# Testing your ChefAI MCP server with MCP Inspector

The MCP Inspector is a free web-based tool that lets you connect to any MCP server and interactively list and call its tools without writing code. Use it to verify the ChefAI MCP server you just built (the one that generates HTML invoices/reports from the expenses CSV).

## Install and launch (PowerShell)

1. Open a PowerShell window.

2. Make sure Node.js is installed (`node --version`). If it is not, install it from nodejs.org.

3. Run:

```
npx -y @modelcontextprotocol/inspector
```

4. A browser window opens with the Inspector UI (usually at `http://localhost:6274`).

## Connect to your ChefAI MCP server (using the UI)

1. In the Inspector UI, click **Add Server** or the **+** button.

2. Choose transport **STDIO**.

3. Set:

   • **Command**: `python`

   • **Arguments**: the full path to your MCP server entry point (for example `C:\path\to\ChefAI\mcp_server\server.py` or whatever file the repo uses)

4. Click **Connect**.

5. Once connected, open the **Tools** tab to see the available tools (invoice/report generators, etc.), fill in any arguments, and call them. The results (including paths to the generated HTML files) appear in the UI.

You can also switch the transport to HTTP if you started the server in HTTP mode and enter the URL shown in the server's console.